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Modelling and Reformulating Constraint Satisfaction Problems

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Foreword

Constraint Programming (CP) is a powerful technology to solve combinatorial problems which are ubiquitous in academia and industry. The last ten years or so have witnessed significant research devoted to modelling and solving problems with constraints. CP is now a mature field and has been successfully used for tackling a wide range of real-life complex applications. However, such a technology is currently accessible to only a small number of experts. For CP to be more widely used by non-experts, more research effort is needed in order to ease the use of the CP technology.

This "Fourth International Workshop of Modelling and Reformulating Constraint Satisfaction Problem" was convened to provide a forum for researchers who share these goals.

This volume contains nine contributed papers. These papers contribute to widen the use of the CP technology. Some of these are application papers describing interesting problems and interesting ways to model them; some contribute to understanding modelling that could guide the manual or automatic formulation of models; some identify some of the criteria that should be used in evaluating models and the design of pragmatic techniques that facilitate the choice among alternative models; some present higher level modelling languages; and some propose automatic reformulation techniques.

We wish to thank all the authors who submitted papers to this workshop; the members of the programme committee; and the CP'2005 Tutorial and Workshop Chairs, Alan Frisch and Ian Miguel.

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Brahim Hnich, Patrick Prosser, and Barbara Smith
Programme Chairs

Programme Committee

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